

HCI 440 A3: Contextual Inquiry	Your team number: 8
Brief Project Title: Integrated Flying Experience	Submission date: February 1, 2017

Project Description

Brief project title: **Integrated Flying experience**

Who are the target users? **General Population, those who travel by plane**

Description of the project.:

This project aims to enhance the experience of people who travel by plane, which includes buying tickets, spending time at the airport, and flying on the plane. Travelers will benefit with useful information and tools before, during and after their flights. This will make the traveling process more enjoyable and worry free.

Script

Screenener. Have you ever flown before? Can you tell me more about your experience?

Inquiry Protocol/Guide

Intro/ Informed Consent	My name is (Sergio/Elizabeth/Sidrah/Aaron). Thank you for meeting with me today. I'm working on a Contextual Inquiry for a DePaul University project focused learning more about what an Integrated Flying Experience would be like. I would like to know more about how you book your flights. There are no right or wrong ways to carry out an activity, or right or wrong answers to my questions; I just want to watch what you do and hear what you have to say. As you perform the activity, your actions and comments will be noted and you will be asked to describe what you are doing. You may be asked questions before, during, or after performing the activity. This meeting should last about 30 to 45 minutes.
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	This activity is voluntary. You have the right not to demonstrate any activity or answer any question, and to stop the inquiry at any time or for any reason. Your actions and responses will be confidential and used only in connection with this class assignment. Only your first name will be used to identify you. If you wish, you can use a pseudonym rather than your real name. Is it OK for me to begin with my requests and questions?
Warm-up and build rapport	[Don't jump directly into the activity, allow some time for warm-up. Start with some small talk about the activity you are investigating. For example: "I'm interested in understanding how students purchase the textbooks that they use in their CDM courses."]
General Inquiry	1. Tell me about the last time you traveled? 2. How comfortable are you with using technology? 3. How do you prefer to present your boarding pass? 4. What does your typical day of flight looks like? 5. How do you prefer to get to the airport? 6. How often do you travel? 7. How do you usually pack? 8. How much in advance do you make plans for travel and book your ticket? 9. What do you usually do in the airport terminals and on the plane?

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Deep focus	1. Imagine if you are asked to travel outside of the state with just a three hour notice, what are some of the things you will do before getting the airport? 2. Is location a big factor in your travels, if so describe what are somethings you look for while planning a vacation? 3. Described the last time you traveled and some of the challenges you faced? 4. Think about the time when you didn't have such a good experience with flying?
Retrospective	1. What could airlines do to make traveling a little easier? 2. What are somethings you think you should do prior to your flight? 3. Is there anything else that would improve your travel experience? Or something that you would change?
Wrap-Up	That concludes the activity. Thank you for your time and for meeting with me.

Subject Information

Sidrah I - Observations:

1)

Brief Discussion: Dr. Zimond is an experienced travels, because he travels for work and other continuing education conference he is well familiar with the airport security and check points. He is single and he usually travels alone, making him a great user for this exercise. Dr. Zimond travels for work at least three times a month. He prefers traveling light and doesn't pack more than a day worth of clothes. Dr. Zimond uses Uber to get to the Airport, once he reaches the terminal he brings out his phone to check his flight status. Dr. Zimond buys most of his tickets online. A day before his trip he

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gets a notification to do a pre-check-in process. Dr. Zimond pre-checks in via phone and attaches his ticket to his passport app on his iPhone. Once, at the gate, he shows the mobile ticket to the boarding representative. The representative scans his boarding pass, and gives him a gesture that he is good to go.

Name: Dr. Zimond

Age: 42

Occupation: Optometrist

Gender: M

User type: Single individual.

Other information: Dr. Zimond is an experienced traveler.

2)

Brief Discussion: Mrs. Bleacher travels once in awhile, she usually travels with her husband, but since her husband had to work and couldn't go with her she decided to take the trip alone with her kids. She is a great user for this exercise because in comparing Dr. Zimond to Mrs. Bleacher's experience as a traveler is completely different and portrays two different perceived idea of how one travels with kids versus alone. Mrs. Bleachers is dropped off to the airport by her husband. Mrs. Bleacher is traveling to arizona to visit her parents. She decides to take her two kids on a trip with her. Child A Aiden (male) is four years old, and Child B Sophia (female) is three years old. Mrs. Bleacher prints all three of their boarding passes before she gets to the airport. Once arrived to the airport, she checks her phone for time. She asks both of her kids if they want to the use the restroom, they both decline. She puts both of them in a stroller and makes her way to the check in line, Where she stands and wait her turns. She fumbles and looks for her boarding passes as she makes her way to the representative. The representative looks at her crumbled boarding pass and scans it patiently watching her yell at her two kids to quiet down.

Name: Mrs. Bleacher and her two kids Aiden and Sophia

Age: 36

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Occupation: Homemaker

Gender: Female

User type: Mother, travelling with two kids.

Other information: Mrs. B doesn't travel often, and tends to get really anxious while travelling with her kids.

Aaron - Observations:

1)

Brief Discussion:

Rachelle has traveled to many places, and she always books her own ticket and flies alone. she likes to visit interesting places and visiting friends. The last time she flew was 4 months ago, where she went to Philadelphia and New Jersey. She Also plans on going to florida next month. Rachelle likes to plan things in advance, and does not like to rush. She also likes to travel lightly. On her recent trip she got TSA precheck and was happy about it.

Rachelle purchases her ticket to fly about 3-4 weeks in advance. She looks on kayak to compare prices and options and pays with a credit card directly on the airline website.

Within 24 hrs before the flight, she prints out her boarding pass, and checks in online. She reserves a taxi the night before, and likes to get to the airport early.

She brings her own food, such as a sandwich and fruit, and always likes to bring an empty water bottle with her so that she does not need to by water in the terminal. She fills up the bottle at a drinking fountain.

At the airport, she goes straight to security, and to her gate, and then goes to the restroom. She likes to go to gift shops to look at souvenirs and buy newspapers, and usually sits down near her gate till the flight.

On the plane she likes to read, do word puzzles, talk to/ meet people, and rest. she shuts her phone off during the flight.

After the flight she may ask airport workers in the destination terminal for directions.

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Some difficulties rachelle has experienced: One trip her flight was delayed and she did not know this until she got to the gate. Also, sometimes there is no room for a carry-on on the the plane, and she needs to check it in at the gate.

To improve her experience rachelle would like to know how long things would take, and how much in advance to be there, such as an ET of when to leave her home.

Name: Rachelle

Age: 56

Occupation: Psychologist

Gender: Female

User type: Single adult traveling alone

Other information: she likes to use her phone it she need it, but also like to take in her surroundings and not be glued to her phone.

2)

Name: Alan

Age: 68

Occupation: Real estate and hedge fund investor

Gender: Male

User type: Married with young adult children. Lives with wife.

Brief Discussion:

Alan travels about 4-5 times a year. He lives in chicago with his wife, has 3 children - 2 are married and

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the 3rd is a graduate student in new york. His trips are usually centered around family events, or business. He also mixes in vacation time as well especially when he goes to conferences and meetings in florida. Alan has been to many places in the US and also overseas. He always likes to fly on a plane that is newer with the latest technology.

Alan tends to book tickets about a week or so in advance. He usually comes to the airport in a rush, close to flight time. Alan has some foot problems and he is tall so he likes to get a good seat on the plane. he travels alone sometimes but usually is with his wife. Alan like to bring a big bag and usually brings more than he needs. He weighs his bag with a bathroom scale once he is packed, and brings an extra small bag incase its overweight

Alan likes to use credit card miles and points to purchase tickets to airlines. He goes on Google Flights, or Kayak to compare options and decides whether to use points or to just use credit card, depending on the prices and airlines.

Alan calls a local taxi service when he is ready to leave for the airport and he pays for it with his credit card. To save time he checks in and brings his bags to curbside check-in, and gets his ticket there. Once in the terminal he likes to get settled at the gate, and buys a newspaper and snacks and goes to the shops. He usually waits till most of the other people have boarded to get on the plane. He may go to the counter and ask for a pre-board, or ask if there are better seats such as bulkhead.

On the plane he usually sits next to his wife, and talks to her. He also likes to read, eat snacks, and use his ipad with wifi.

Alans experiences have been mostly smooth overall, but one thing he would like is having more TSA personnel at the airport, so there are not as many long lines at security. He would also would prefer less fees.

Other information:

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2)

Name: Sam

Age: 25

Occupation: graduate Student, Works part time

Gender: Male

User type: single, usually travels alone

Brief Discussion:

Sam is usually in new york, takes graduate courses online and works part time. His family lives in chicago. He travels fairly often from chicago to new york, and also enjoys going on vacation to places like florida. He tends to be in a rush when he is leaving and arrives at the airport close to his flight. He usually goes on google flights to see all the flights available, and then also looks on southwest (bc google does not include it). After he know what flight he wants, his parents book the flight for him with either points or credit card. He tends to wait till a week before, sometimes even a few days before to decide on a flight.

Sam tends to bring more than he needs on his trips but usually does not have an issue with overweight bags.

To get to the airport, Sam takes an Uber, or gets a ride from his dad. He says recently he got 2 free rides from the airport with a Uber promotion.

If it's close to his flight he goes to curbside check in, or if he has more time goes to the self check-in computers, and gets his ticket there.

In the terminal Sam likes to get snacks and food, walk around, and use the restroom before the flight. He also watches a sports game if there is one on the TV's.

On the plane Sam likes to play puzzle games on his iphone, watch the entertainment on his personal in-seat TV or overhead tv. He loves looking out the window at the scenery and watching the plane take off and land. He even takes pictures if there is something nice to see. Sam also enjoys looking at the

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magazines. He tends to not be able to do much work for school on the plane, and likes to just relax.

Sam once came to the airport but his flight was delayed. He told me though that he had previously bought on ebay 2 passes to the United airlines lounge. He used it and went to the lounge to relax. He told me it was a good experience, and that he bought 2 more which he will use the next time he has extra time or his flight is delayed.

Sam also says that he hates when he forgets his headphones and can't use the airlines entertainment. He would like to have his phone remind him of things he tends to forget.

Other information: Sam is an experience user. He is computer savvy and knows ways to make his flight more comfortable.

Elizabeth - Observations

1)

Name: Margo

Age: 20

Occupation: Student

Gender: Female

User type: Single traveler

Margo is very advance in technology. She uses a variety of mechanisms to gain information on travel and flights. When she is at home she relies mainly on her computer, however, when away, she will rely heavily on her smartphone. Margo lives in Chicago and she enjoys travel to many different places. These include Europe and the Caribbean.

Margo enjoys searching online and using a computer to gain the content she needs for a trip. In her many travels, she will always begin with looking on the computer on website such as Expedia and

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cheaptickets.com. She would rather have an all inclusive sight that encompasses air, land and sea travel options. What is most important to her is that she able to gain a variety of information in one place. She would like to be able to see not only information that is available at the airport, but also at her destination. In doing this Margo is very inept and navigating thru website content and pages. She is willing to take the necessary clicks to gain more information. It would seem that her main goal is to give up the walk-up-and-use learnability to get more information on her flights, etc.

When proposing different scenarios to Margo, she explained several tasks that she would perform to get this critical information. Margo searches for information at home far in advance of her trip. She will book her tickets online via travel website. This will include her hotel and ground transportation. Once the day arrives, she will use her smartphone to track the flights times and the destination weather, etc. Upon arrival at the airport, she will use her smartphone app to track her flight, luggage and weather. Until it is time for her to leave, she will receive pop up alters informing her of food and entertainment that is available at her destination and at the airport.

In summary, Margo is a user who will forgo the number of clicks to gain information on her ticket and more. Her characteristics demonstrate that she would be open to pull downs, a tabular format, alerts and more for her flight experience.

2)

Name: Karen

Age: 45

Occupation: Customer Service Rep/Healthcare

Gender: Female

User type: Parent with Small children

Karen is a full time working grandma who travels frequently with her grandchildren and her husband.

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Karen does enjoy travelling to many different places including Europe and Mexico. She does travel with her husband and sometimes she will travel with her daughter and grandchildren. Karen works a full time job and does have to travel for business occasionally. She does rely upon the company travel agent to book all of her travel, but does need to research the destinations that she travels to for business because they are frequently different. She is not very comfortable with the using the computer or using devices to get information that she needs. She will often take her needs to a travel agent and have them book tickets for her.

Karen will begin her planning at home on a computer, however, she does not enjoy this task. She will often call someone else to ask them to find information on flights, hotels and ground transportation. She will select her options and then print them so that she can go thru them manually. Once she is done with sifting thru the printouts, she will go back to the computer and make her selections, buy tickets and book hotel reservations over the phone. On the travel day, Karen will have printouts of all emails that she received from the travel sites she used or the hotels she called for reservations. She will typically get a ride to the airport and ask her husband to take as well. Upon arriving at the airport, she will have all the printouts and check the flight status via the boards in the airport. She will also ask airport workers to assist her with finding the gate, etc. Karen will use an app to receive updates on flight status; but does not prefer to use this method to gain information. She will also use her smartphone to get access to restaurants and entertainment at her destination and in the airport, but only when she can't call a number.

In summary, Karen is not a user that is comfortable with technology. She will use it to gain the minimum amount of information, but prefers to use manual methods for information.

Sergio Flores - Observations

1)

Name: Oscar

Age: 21

Occupation: Student

Gender: Male

User type: Single, young male

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Brief Description:

Oscar likes the convenience of flying but doesn't like dealing with time consuming tasks. So he typically purchases his tickets through an airline's mobile app. First, he compares prices on Google Flights before making a final purchase, however he tends to stick to the same airline because of the convenience he's experienced. If the airline has a mobile app, he'll use that airlines' mobile app most of the time. However, he has booked using apps like Kayak. If and when he uses the airline's mobile app, he also uses the mobile app to check-in to his flight and to board the plane using a digital ticket that he scans at the gate at boarding time. For any luggage that needs to be checked-in, he uses the automated kiosks and drops off his luggage on the way to the gate. After the flight, he picks up his luggage and goes about his day.

Oscar is a full-time student and lives in Monterrey, Mexico. He has 2 siblings and a large extended family. His travels are focused around tourism and educational trips. He has flown to NYC, Madrid, Mexico City, and Chicago.

2)

Name: Luis

Age: 35

Occupation: Manager @ Large eCommerce Company

Gender: Male

User type: Married male, no children

Brief Description:

Luis is a manager at a large eCommerce company. He travels for business and personal reasons throughout the year. When he travels for business, most of the logistics around booking the flight are handled by his company's travel and expense department. However, when he travels for personal reasons – he likes to have things be as seamless as possible.

He likes comparing prices on Google Flights, Kayak, and Priceline.com – He has a credit card that allows him to accumulate points regardless of what airline he travels with, so he has flexibility. However, he tends to be loyal to a few airlines – depending on the route and destination. He has been to Hong Kong, Madrid, Chicago, NYC, Bogota, and Mexico City.

Once he picks a flight, if the airline has an in-app booking system, he will take advantage of that and then use the app to check-in on the day of the flight, and then board the flight using a digital boarding pass – dropping off his luggage on the way to the flight using an automated kiosk, if he has luggage to

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check-in. There are times he travels with carry-ons only.

After the flight, he picks up his luggage (if he checked-in any prior to boarding) and then he goes about his day.

Observations, Insights, and Insight Clusters

Stormboard link: <https://stormboard.com/invite/400019/panel673>

Stormboard ID: 400019

Stormboard Key: panel673

Observations

- Do they travel lightly or overpack?
- Two different types of Users, Single individual versus families.
- are they tight on time/ in a rush, or not
- Methods for searching & purchasing flights:
Expedia, cheaptickets.com, priceline, kayak, Google flights, directly on airline website
- Reasons for travel
 - Business, Vacation, Family visits
- Where do they travel?
 - Places such as Philadelphia, New York, Florida, Israel, Madrid, Mexico, Chicago, Europe, Caribbean
- Frequency of travel
- Do they print their tickets out or use app stubs for ticketing purposes?
- Do they travel with others or alone, or with kids?
- How do they check in?
 - Online at home, on phone, curbside check-in, kiosk, airline counter
- How much in advance do they make plans?
few days, 1-2 weeks, 3-4 weeks, more than a month
- What comfort level are they at with technology?
- What are their goals as a user? Power performance? walk-up-and-use learnability,
- What are their imperatives?
- What activities do they do in the airport and on the plane?
 - Airport: relax by gate or lounge, get snacks, go to shops, browse souvenirs, go to

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restroom, fill empty water bottle at drinking fountain, watch tv's, buy newspaper, check flight status, ask for an upgrade or better seat, make calls, check email.

- Plane: watch movies, tv shows on phone, or use airplane entertainment systems. Look out window at scenery, take pictures, talk to person sitting next to you such as a friend or other person. Eat food, listen to music, play puzzle on iphone or in magazines. watch tv if available, read book or magazine, use restroom
- Mode of transportation to the airport such as cab, uber, or a family member drops them off?

Insights

The team found that there are several user characteristics that change the user experience goals and imperatives.

Some of these include:

- Different users that use technology differently
- A pattern of users older than 35 prefer printed tickets versus young business travelers prefer to use their phone app for their ticket stubs and users who frequently travel tend to be less anxious because they only have to worry about themselves.
- Individuals who travel with children have goals that pertain to timing and location of food and restrooms. Business travelers prefer to travel light versus users who travel with children tend to pack heavy.
- In general, the people we've interviewed have traveled to various locations around the world.
- Some features users suggested that we did not think of were implementation of skymall, exercises/ stretches for when on the plane, and packing reminders.

Insight Clusters

Based on the insights gathered, the team found the following clusters:

- Majority used Smartphones for Updates
- Older travelers don't rely on technology when traveling
- Location of food, restaurants, restrooms, ticket counters, baggage claim area, ground transportation are important
- All users prefer to have the app provide airport/destination navigation
- Users use technology to purchase flights

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- All users, whether they were single, parent/child/family had pre-trip planning activities

Process Retrospective

Flight reminders

GPS navigation

Airline/Airport specific maps

While on the plane; having skymall on the app

Weather delays displayed for destination and current location

Team Member Contributions

Team Member Name	Specific Contributions
Aaron	Full collaboration, project description, 3 subjects observed, insights, observations, stormboard
Liz	Full collaboration, conferencing mode, Retrospectives, Contextual Inquiry, Insight Cluster, Observations, 2 subjects observed, stormboard
Sidrah	Full collaboration, 2 subjects observed, Stormboard setup, Insight, Contextual Inquiry
Sergio	Full collaboration, 2 subjects observed, insights, observations, process retrospective, stormboard, submit assignment

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Appendix

[Include a complete **blank** copy of the contextual inquiry protocol here.]

Contextual Inquiry Protocol

Screener. [Example: “Are you a graduate student in CDM? Have you purchased any textbooks for your courses?”]

Inquiry Protocol/Guide

Intro/ Informed Consent	
Warm-up and build rapport	
General Inquiry	
Deep focus	

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Retrospective	
Wrap-Up	